PARTS OF SPEECH – PART II

Preposition | Conjunction | Interjection | Articles

1. PREPOSITION

1.1 What is a Preposition?

A **preposition** is a word placed before a noun or pronoun to show the relationship between that noun and another word in the sentence.

The word "pre-position" means: "placed before"

Structure: Preposition + Noun = Prepositional Phrase

Example:

The book is on the table.

on → preposition the table → object of preposition

1.2 Why Are Prepositions Important?

Prepositions tell us:

- Where? (place)
- When? (time)
- How? (manner)
- Direction?
- Cause?
- Relationship?

They are heavily tested in TNTET through:

✔ Error detection ✔ Choose correct preposition

1.3 Prepositions of Place

IN

Used for:

✔ Enclosed space
✔ Countries, cities
✔ Large areas

Examples:

The money is in the box.
She lives in Chennai.
Fish live in water.

ON

Used for:

✔ Surface
✔ Contact with surface

Examples:

The book is on the table.
The picture is on the wall.

AT

Used for:

✔ Specific point

✔ Exact location

Examples:

She is at the bus stop.

They are at school.

Important Difference

He is in the room. (inside)

He is at the room. ❌ (wrong)

He is at the door. ✔ (specific point)

1.4 Prepositions of Time

IN → months, years, long periods

in March

in 2020

in the morning

ON → days, dates

on Monday

on 15th August

AT → exact time

at 5 pm

at midnight

Common TNTET error:

❌ in Monday ✔ on Monday

1.5 Prepositions of Direction

to → movement towards

into → movement inside

onto → movement onto surface

Examples:

She went to school.

He jumped into the river.

The cat climbed onto the roof.

1.6 Preposition After Adjectives (Important)

Certain adjectives require specific prepositions:

afraid of

interested in

fond of

good at

angry with

Example:

She is interested in music.

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2. CONJUNCTION

1. What is a Conjunction?

A **conjunction** is a word that joins:

- Words
- Phrases
- Clauses

In simple terms: A conjunction connects ideas.

Example:

Ravi and Ramesh are friends.

She is poor but honest.

- Without conjunctions, sentences become disconnected.

TYPES OF CONJUNCTIONS

There are three main types:

1. Coordinating Conjunction
2. Subordinating Conjunction
3. Correlative Conjunction

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1. COORDINATING CONJUNCTION

A **coordinating conjunction** joins:

- Two words
- Two phrases
- Two independent clauses that are grammatically equal.

The 7 Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

F – For
A – And
N – Nor
B – But
O – Or
Y – Yet
S – So

Function of Each

1. AND (Addition) - Adds similar ideas.

She bought apples and oranges.

He is kind and helpful.

2. BUT (Contrast) - Shows contrast.

He is poor but honest.

She tried hard but failed.

3. OR (Choice) - Shows alternative.

You can stay or leave.

Tea or coffee?

4. **SO (Result) -** Shows result.

It was raining, so we stayed home.

5. **FOR (Reason – formal)**

She did not attend the meeting, for she was unwell.

(Note: Rare in modern usage)

6. **NOR (Negative addition)**

He did not call, nor did he write.

7. **YET (Contrast)**

She is weak, yet she won.

Remember

When joining two independent clauses with coordinating conjunction:
Comma + conjunction - She was tired, but she continued working.

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2. SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTION

A **subordinating conjunction** connects:

- A dependent clause to
- An independent clause

It makes one clause dependent.

What is a Dependent Clause?

A clause that:

✔ Has subject and verb

❌ Does NOT express complete meaning alone

Example:

Because he was tired… (incomplete)

Common Subordinating Conjunctions

because
although
though
if
when
while
since
unless
before
after
until

Function Categories

1. Reason

because
since
I stayed home because I was sick.

---

2. Contrast

although
though
Although he is poor, he is honest.

---

3. Condition

if
unless
If it rains, we will cancel the match.
Unless you study, you will fail.

---

4. Time

when
while
before
after
until
When she arrived, we started the meeting.
Wait until I return.

Important Structure

Subordinate Clause + Main Clause
Although he is rich, he is unhappy.

OR

Main Clause + Subordinate Clause
He is unhappy although he is rich.

Common TNTET Error

❌ Because he was tired, so he slept.
✔ Because he was tired, he slept.
✔ He was tired, so he slept.

Never use “because” and “so” together.

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3. CORRELATIVE CONJUNCTION

Correlative conjunctions work in pairs to join equal elements.
They always appear together.

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Common Pairs

either…or
neither…nor
both…and
not only…but also
Whether…or

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1. Either…Or (Choice)

Either Ravi or Ramesh is responsible.
Agreement Rule: Verb agrees with the nearer subject.
Either the teacher or the students are present.
Either the students or the teacher is present.

---

2. Neither…Nor (Negative Choice)

Neither Ravi nor Ramesh was present.
The same agreement rule applies.

---

3. Both…And (Addition)

Both Ravi and Ramesh are present.
Verbs are plural.

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4. Not Only…But Also (Emphasis)

She is not only intelligent but also hardworking.

Clear Comparison Table

Type	Joins	Example
Coordinating	Equal clauses	She is poor but honest.
Subordinating	Dependent + main clause	Because it rained, we stayed home.
Correlative	Paired words	Either Ravi or Ramesh is coming.

Frequently Tested in TNTET

✔ Because vs So
✔ Although vs But
✔ Either…or agreement
✔ Identify conjunction type
✔ Choose correct conjunction
✔ Error correction

Remember:

"Coordinating conjunctions join equals, subordinating conjunctions create dependence, and correlative conjunctions work in pairs."

3. INTERJECTION

1. What is an Interjection?

An **interjection** is a word or short expression that shows sudden emotion, feeling, or reaction.

It expresses emotion directly rather than grammatically connecting with the sentence.

In simple terms: An interjection expresses feeling.

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2. Key Characteristics of Interjections

1. They express sudden emotion.
2. They are grammatically independent.
3. They are often followed by an exclamation mark (!).
4. They do not change form.

Example:

Hurrah! We won the match.

"Hurrah!" expresses joy.

It is not grammatically connected to the rest of the sentence.

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3. Why Are Interjections Called Independent?

Because: If we remove the interjection, the sentence still makes sense.

Example:

Alas! He failed the exam.

He failed the exam. ✔ (complete meaning)

So "Alas!" is emotionally expressive, not grammatically necessary.

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4. Types of Interjections (Based on Emotion)

Interjections can be grouped according to the feeling they express.

4.1 Joy / Happiness

Hurrah!

Wow!

Bravo!

Yippee!

Examples:

Hurrah! We have won the match.

Wow! That is amazing.

Bravo! You performed well.

4.2 Sorrow / Grief

Alas!

Oh no!

Examples:

Alas! The soldier died in the battle.
Oh no! I lost my wallet.

4.3 Surprise

Oh!
Ah!
What!

Examples:

Oh! I did not see you there.
Ah! Now I understand.

4.4 Pain

Ouch!
Ow!

Examples:

Ouch! That hurts.
Ow! I hit my head.

4.5 Anger / Disgust

Ugh!
Oh! (depending on tone)

Example: Ugh! This food is terrible.

4.6 Approval / Praise

Bravo!
Well done!

Example: Bravo! That was excellent.

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5. Position of Interjections

Interjections usually appear:

- ✔ At the beginning of a sentence
- ✔ Sometimes in the middle
- ✔ Rarely at the end

Beginning Position (Most Common)

Hurrah! We won.
Alas! He is no more.

Middle Position

I was, oh, very surprised.

End Position

You won, hurrah!

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6. Punctuation Rules

Interjections are usually followed by:

- ✔ Exclamation mark (!)
- ✔ Sometimes comma (if emotion is mild)

Strong emotion:

Wow! That is great.

Mild emotion:

Oh, I see.

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7. Difference Between Interjection and Other Parts of Speech

Interjection vs Exclamation Sentence

Interjection:

Oh!

Hurrah!

Exclamatory sentence:

What a beautiful day!

"What" here is not an interjection; it is part of the sentence structure.

Interjection vs Adverb

She shouted loudly. *(loudly = adverb)*

Oh! She shouted. *(Oh = interjection)*

Adverbs modify verbs.

Interjection expresses emotion.

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8. Interjections in TN State Board Textbooks

In Classes 3–6, interjections are introduced as:

"Words that express sudden feelings."

Examples commonly given:

Hurrah!

Alas!

Oh!

In higher classes, students are asked to:

- ✔ Identify interjections
- ✔ Use correct punctuation
- ✔ Choose appropriate interjection

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9. Common TNTET Question Patterns

- ✔ Identify the interjection in the sentence.
- ✔ Choose the correct interjection for the situation.
- ✔ Fill in the blank with appropriate interjections.

Example:

_____! We have won the match.

A) Alas B) Hurrah C) Oh D) Ouch

Answer: Hurrah

10. Important Clarification

Interjections:

- ✔ Do not connect ideas (unlike conjunctions).
- ✔ Do not modify nouns (unlike adjectives).
- ✔ Do not modify verbs (unlike adverbs).
- ✔ Do not show relationships (unlike prepositions).
- ✔ They only express emotion.

11. Structural Example

Sentence:

Alas! The old man died.

Alas → Interjection

The old man → Subject

died → Verb

Remove "Alas":

The old man died. (complete sentence)

Therefore, interjection is emotionally expressive, not structurally necessary.

12. Remember

"An interjection is a word that expresses sudden emotion and stands outside the grammar of the sentence."

13. Summary Table

Emotion	Interjection	Example
Joy	Hurrah!	Hurrah! We won.
Sorrow	Alas!	Alas! He failed.
Surprise	Oh!	Oh! I forgot.
Pain	Ouch!	Ouch! That hurts.
Praise	Bravo!	Bravo! Well done.

4. ARTICLES

1. WHAT IS AN ARTICLE?

An **article** is a word placed before a noun to specify whether the noun is:

- General
- Specific
- Known
- Unknown

Articles are a type of **determiner**.

They limit or define the noun.

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2. TYPES OF ARTICLES

There are three articles in English:

1. **a**
2. **an**
3. **the**

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3. INDEFINITE ARTICLES – "A" and "AN"

3.1 Why Called "Indefinite"?

They refer to:

- A non-specific person or thing
- One of many

Example:

I saw a dog.

(Not a specific dog.)

3.2 Rule for "A"

Use **"a"** before:

✔ Words that begin with a **consonant sound**

Examples:

a book

a teacher

a pen

a university

Important:

"University" begins with vowel letter 'u',

but the sound is "yu" → consonant.

So we use "a".

✔ a university

❌ an university

3.3 Rule for "AN"

Use **"an"** before:

✔ Words that begin with a **vowel sound**

✔ தமிழில் அ முதல் ஔ வரை நினைவில் கொள்க

Examples:

an apple

an umbrella

an elephant

3.4 Sound Rule (Very Important)

Articles depend on **sound**, not spelling.

Examples:

an hour ✔ (silent 'h')

a European ✔ (sound "yu")

an honest man ✔ (silent 'h')

a one-rupee coin ✔ (sound "w")

3.5 When Do We Use A/AN?

1. Before singular countable nouns

She is a teacher.

He bought an umbrella.

2. To mean "one"

I waited for an hour. (one hour)

3. When introducing something for the first time

I saw a cat. The cat was black.

First mention → a

Second mention → the

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4. DEFINITE ARTICLE – "THE"

4.1 Why Called "Definite"?

Used when the noun is:

✔ Specific

✔ Known

✔ Unique

Example:

The sun rises in the east.

There is only one sun.

4.2 Uses of "THE"

1. When noun is already known

I saw a dog. The dog was barking.

First time → a dog

Second time → the dog

2. With Unique Things

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The sun
The moon
The earth

3. With Rivers, Oceans, Seas, Mountain Ranges

The Ganga
The Indian Ocean
The Himalayas
But:
Mount Everest ❌ (no "the")

4. With Superlatives

The tallest boy
The best student
The most intelligent girl

Rule:

The superlative degree always takes "the".

5. With Musical Instruments

He plays the violin.
She plays the piano.

6. With Ordinal Numbers

The first prize
The second chapter

7. With Adjectives Referring to a Class

The poor need help.
The rich are not always happy.

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5. ZERO ARTICLE (NO ARTICLE)

Sometimes we use NO article.
This is very important for TNTET.

5.1 Before Proper Nouns

India
Chennai
Ravi

❌ The Ravi
❌ The India

(Except specific cases like "The United States")

5.2 Before Abstract Nouns (General Meaning)

Honesty is important.
Education is necessary.
But:

The education system is changing. *(specific system)*

5.3 Before Plural Nouns (General Meaning)

Books are useful.

Teachers work hard.

But:

The books on the table are mine. *(specific books)*

5.4 Before Names of Meals

We had lunch.

She ate dinner.

But:

The dinner we had yesterday was delicious. *(specific dinner)*

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6. COMMON ERRORS (Very Important for TNTET)

Error 1

❌ He is a honest man. ✔ He is an honest man.

Error 2

❌ She is an European. ✔ She is a European.

Error 3

❌ Ganga is holy river. ✔ The Ganga is a holy river.

Error 4

❌ The honesty is good. ✔ Honesty is good.

Error 5

❌ He is best player. ✔ He is the best player.

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7. FIRST MENTION vs SECOND MENTION RULE

Very Important Concept

Example:

I bought a book.

The book is interesting.

First mention → a

Second mention → the

---

8. ARTICLES WITH GEOGRAPHICAL NAMES

Use "the" with:

The United States

The Netherlands

The Philippines

No "the" with:

India

Sri Lanka

Japan

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9. ARTICLES WITH COUNTABLE & UNCOUNTABLE NOUNS

Singular countable noun MUST have:

a
an
the

❌ She is teacher. ✔ She is a teacher.

Uncountable nouns generally do not take a/an.

❌ an advice ✔ a piece of advice

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10. STRUCTURAL ANALYSIS EXAMPLE

Sentence:

The teacher gave a book to the student.

The teacher → specific
a book → non-specific
the student → specific

---

11. QUICK SUMMARY TABLE

Article	Meaning	Example
a	non-specific (consonant sound)	a pen
an	non-specific (vowel sound)	an apple
the	specific/unique	the sun

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12. TNTET FREQUENTLY TESTED AREAS

✔ a/an based on sound
✔ Article omission
✔ Superlative + the
✔ River names
✔ Proper nouns
✔ First mention rule
✔ Abstract nouns

Remember

"Use 'a' or 'an' for something not specific, use 'the' for something specific or unique, and use no article when speaking in general."

Frequent TNTET Focus Areas

Prepositions:

✔ in/on/at

Conjunction:

✔ because vs so
✔ although usage
✔ either…or agreement

Articles:

- ✔ a/an distinction
- ✔ the + superlative
- ✔ article omission

Interjection:

- ✔ identification

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